

5. Replace Values

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-

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- Convert columns → rows
-

REPLACE VALUES

Replace Values is used to clean and standardize data by replacing:

specific values

partial text inside values

multiple occurrences

NULL values
errors
inconsistent spellings

This is one of the most used cleaning tools in Power Query.

Sample Dataset for Replace Values Topic

EmpID	City	Status	Rating	Comments
101	Chennai	Active	4	N/A
102	Mumbai	Inactive	Error	Excllent
103	null	Active	5	Average
104	Banglore	Actve	3	Poor
105	Chennai	Active	4	NA
106	Hyderbad	Inactive	2	Excellent

This data contains:

- **NULL values**
- **Spelling mistakes**
- **N/A variations**
- **City spelling errors**
- **Unwanted text values**
- **Error text**

We will clean everything using Replace Values.

1. REPLACE A SINGLE VALUE

Business Need:

Replace inconsistent values to maintain data quality.

Example:

Replace "Banglore" → "Bangalore"

Output:

City Before	City After
Banglore	Bangalore

Use Cases:

- Fix product names
 - Fix misspelled city names
 - Replace old brand names
-

2. REPLACE MULTIPLE OCCURRENCES (Same Value Appears Many Times)

Dataset Has:

- "N/A"
- "NA"
- "N-A"
- "N/A "

Goal: Convert all these to blank.

Replace Values Steps:

Replace "N/A" → ""

Replace "NA" → ""

Output:

Comments Before	Comments After
N/A	(blank)
NA	(blank)

Use Cases:

- Cleaning missing data
 - Standardizing multiple variations of NULL
 - Removing placeholder text
-

3. REPLACE SPECIFIC PART OF TEXT

Power Query also replaces substring inside text.

Example:

Replace "Active" → "Active"

It fixes embedded text errors.

Before → After:

Status Before	Status After
Active	Active

More Examples:

- Replace "Hyderbad" → "Hyderabad"
- Replace "Excllent" → "Excellent"
- Replace "Chennai City" → "Chennai"

Business Scenarios:

- Fixing typos inside product descriptions
 - Removing version numbers
 - Standardizing “Ltd.” vs “Limited”
-

4. REPLACE NULL VALUES

NULL means *missing*.

Example:

Replace NULL in “City” → “Unknown”

Output:

City Before	City After
null	Unknown

Why Important?

- Dashboards break if NULL exists
- Replacement makes visualizations cleaner
- Helps grouping and segmentation

5. REPLACE ERRORS

Errors appear due to:

- Wrong data type
- Division by zero
- Text in numeric column
- Conversion errors

Replace Errors is used to fix ALL error rows.

Example:

Rating column contains "Error"

Step:

Replace Errors → Replace with 0

Output:

Rating Before	Rating After
Error	0
4	4
5	5

Business Uses:

- Replace data conversion errors
- Avoid breaking dashboards

- **Maintain numeric columns without errors**

6. REPLACE TYPES (Changing Data Types Using Replace Rule)

Although not common, Replace Types means → when converting data types, Power Query may auto-replace invalid values.

Example:

Trying to convert "Error" to Number → becomes Error Row,
then using Replace Errors → replace with 0.

Example Flow:

1. **Change Type → Error**
2. **Replace Errors → 0**

EXAMPLES USING SAMPLE DATA

Below is the step-by-step cleaned output.

Example 1: NULL → “Unknown”

City Before	City After
null	Unknown

Example 2: “N/A” → blank

Comments Before Comments After

N/A	(blank)
NA	(blank)

Example 3: Spelling Fix

Before After

Banglore	Bangalore
Hyderbad	Hyderabad
Excllent	Excellent

Example 4: Remove text errors

Status Before	Status After
Active	Active

Example 5: Replace Errors

If Rating = “Error”, replace with 0

Before	After
Error	0

REMOVE ROWS

Remove Rows is used for cleaning datasets by deleting unwanted rows such as:

- extra headers
- blank rows
- error rows

- duplicates
- alternate pattern rows

This is one of the first steps in data cleaning.

Sample Dataset

Row	EmpID	Name	Salary
1	EmpID	Name	Salary
2	101	John	45000
3			
4	102	Maria	55000
5	ERROR	Rahul	60000
6	103	Priya	50000
7	103	Priya	50000
8	104	David	70000
9			
10	105	John	45000

This dataset contains:

- ✓ repeated header
- ✓ blanks
- ✓ errors
- ✓ duplicates
- ✓ dirty rows

We will use **Remove Rows** to clean everything.

1. REMOVE TOP ROWS

Used when files contain:

- ✓ extra headers
- ✓ notes
- ✓ metadata
- ✓ unwanted intro rows

Example:

Remove first **1** row (because row 1 contains repeated header).

Before:

Row	EmpID	Name	Salary
1	EmpID	Name	Salary
2	101	John	45000

After:

Row	EmpID	Name	Salary
2	101	John	45000

2. REMOVE BOTTOM ROWS

Used when:

- ✓ file ends with footnotes
- ✓ extra total lines
- ✓ blank rows at bottom
- ✓ unnecessary summaries

Example:

Remove last **1** row (blank row 9 or footer row).

Before:

Row	EmpID	Name	Salary
-----	-------	------	--------

9	(blank)	(blank)	(blank)
---	---------	---------	---------

After:

Blank row at bottom removed.

3. REMOVE ALTERNATE ROWS

Used for:

- ✓ Sample data selection
- ✓ Removing every 2nd row from messy sensor data
- ✓ Removing noise from log files

Example Scenario:

Remove every alternate row starting from row 2.

Definition:

- Start removing at row 2
- Remove 1 row
- Keep 1 row
(Repeat)

Before:

Row	EmpID	Name
1	101	John
2	102	Maria
3	103	Priya
4	104	David
5	105	John

After:

Row	EmpID	Name
1	101	John
3	103	Priya
5	105	John

4. REMOVE BLANK ROWS

Blank rows break dashboards and cause errors.

Example:

Before:

Row	EmpID	Name	Salary
3			

After removing blank rows:

Row 3 removed.

Use Cases:

- Cleaning Excel-based datasets
 - Removing empty lines from CSV
 - Preparing consistent data for modeling
-

5. REMOVE ERRORS

Removes rows that display **Error** due to:

- invalid data type
- division by zero
- text in numeric columns
- failed transformations

Example:

Before:

EmpID	Name	Salary
ERROR	Rahul	60000

After Remove Errors:

Row removed.

Use Cases:

- Ensure numeric columns contain only numbers
 - Fix issues during refresh
 - Remove corrupt values
-

6. REMOVE DUPLICATES

Duplicates cause wrong totals, wrong counts, and wrong KPIs.

Example:

Before:

EmpID	Name	Salary
103	Priya	50000
103	Priya	50000

After:

Only 1 row kept.

Use Cases:

- Customer master
 - Employee master
 - Sales transaction cleanup
 - Attendance logs
-

FULL CLEANING PROCESS (BUSINESS LEVEL)

Using all Remove Row operations:

Input Messy File:

Row	EmpID	Name	Salary
1	EmpID	Name	Salary
2	101	John	45000
3	(blank)	(blank)	(blank)
4	102	Maria	55000
5	ERROR	Rahul	60000
6	103	Priya	50000
7	103	Priya	50000
8	104	David	70000
9	(blank)	(blank)	(blank)
10	105	John	45000

Step-by-step Cleaning:

Remove Top Rows (remove repeated header)

Remove Blank Rows

Remove Errors

Remove Duplicates

Final Clean Output:

EmpID	Name	Salary
101	John	45000

102	Maria	55000
103	Priya	50000
104	David	70000
105	John	45000

KEEP ROWS in Power Query

Keeping rows means selecting only the rows you WANT to keep and removing all others.

Power Query provides 5 options:

1. **Keep Top Rows**
2. **Keep Bottom Rows**
3. **Keep Range of Rows**

4. Keep Duplicates

5. Keep Errors

Sample Dataset (Sales Transactions)

Use this dataset for all examples:

TransactionID	Region	Amount	Status
1001	North	5000	Completed
1002	South	4200	Completed
1003	East	3200	Failed
1004	North	6000	Completed
1005	West	ERROR	Error
1006	South	2500	Completed
1007	East	1800	Completed
1008	West	3000	Completed
1009	North	1500	Failed

1. Keep Top Rows

Keeps ONLY the first N rows.

Use Case:

Your manager asks:

“I need the first 3 transactions for testing.”

Steps:

Home → **Keep Rows** → Keep Top Rows → Enter 3

Example Output:

TransactionID	Region	Amount	Status
1001	North	5000	Completed
1002	South	4200	Completed
1003	East	3200	Failed

2. Keep Bottom Rows

Keeps ONLY the last N rows.

Use Case:

QA team needs:

“Give me the last 2 transactions to verify data entry.”

Steps:

Home → **Keep Rows** → Keep Bottom Rows → Enter 2

Example Output:

TransactionID	Region	Amount	Status
1008	West	3000	Completed
1009	North	1500	Failed

3. Keep Range of Rows

Keeps rows starting from a position and number of rows.

Format:

- **Start Index** (0-based indexing)
 - **Number of rows to keep**
-

Use Case:

Manager says:

“Bring only rows from 3rd to 6th for middle-section analysis.”

Rows needed = Start at row 2 (because index starts from 0) and keep 4 rows.

Steps:

Home → **Keep Rows** → Keep Range of Rows

Start = **2**

Count = **4**

Output:

TransactionID	Region	Amount	Status
1003	East	3200	Failed
1004	North	6000	Completed
1005	West	ERROR	Error
1006	South	2500	Completed

4. Keep Duplicates

Keeps only rows where duplicates exist.

Modify dataset to explain duplicates:

TransactionID	Region	Amount	Status
1001	North	5000	Completed
1002	South	4200	Completed
1003	East	3200	Completed
1003	East	3200	Completed
1004	North	6000	Failed

Here, **TransactionID 1003** is duplicated.

Use Case:

Finance team:

“Show me only duplicate transactions for audit.”

Steps:

Home → Keep Rows → **Keep Duplicates**

Output:

TransactionID	Region	Amount	Status
1003	East	3200	Completed
1003	East	3200	Completed

5. Keep Errors

Keeps ONLY rows that contain errors.

Example Error Row:

TransactionID	Region	Amount	Status
1005	West	ERROR	Error

Use Case:

Your team wants to:

“Extract only rows with data issues so we can fix them separately.”

Steps:

Home → Keep Rows → **Keep Errors**

Output:

TransactionID	Region	Amount	Status
1005	West	ERROR	Error

FILTER ROWS in Power Query

Filtering rows means selecting only the rows you **want to keep based on a condition**.

Power Query provides 5 types of filters:

1. **Number Filters**
2. **Text Filters**
3. **Date Filters**
4. **Custom Filters**

5. Basic vs Advanced Filtering

Sample Dataset (Sales Orders)

OrderID	Region	Order Date	Amount	Status
101	North	2024-01-05	5000	Completed
102	South	2024-01-12	2500	Pending
103	East	2024-02-10	8000	Completed
104	East	2023-12-28	1000	Cancelled
105	West	2024-03-02	1500	Completed
106	South	2024-03-15	9500	Completed
107	West	2024-01-18	4000	Pending

1. Number Filters

Used for columns with numeric values (Amount column).

Available Options

- Equals (=)
- Not equals (≠)
- Greater Than
- Less Than
- Between
- Top 10% / Top 10 Values
- Bottom 10% / Bottom 10 Values

Business Question:

“Show me all orders greater than ₹5,000.”

Steps

Column **Amount** → Filter → **Number Filters** → **Greater Than** → **5000**

Result:

OrderID	Region	Amount	Status
103	East	8000	Completed
106	South	9500	Completed

Another Example (Between):

“Show orders between ₹2,000 and ₹5,000.”

Amount → Number Filters → **Between**

2. Text Filters

Used for columns containing text (Region, Status).

Available Options

- Equals
 - Does Not Equal
 - Begins With
 - Ends With
 - Contains
 - Does Not Contain
-

Business Question:

“Give me only East region orders.”

Steps

Column **Region** → Filter → **Text Filters** → **Equals** → **East**

Result:

OrderID	Region	Amount	Status
103	East	8000	Completed
104	East	1000	Cancelled

Another Example (Contains):

“Show orders where Status contains ‘Pend’ (Pending).”

Status → Text Filters → Contains → Pend

3. Date Filters

Used for date columns (Order Date).

Available Options

- Before
 - After
 - Between
 - This Year / Month / Quarter
 - Last Year
 - Next Month
 - Year-to-Date
 - Custom date selection
-

Business Question:

“Show only orders from January 2024.”

Steps

Order Date → Filter → **Date Filters** → **In This Month** → **January 2024**

Result:

OrderID	Order Date	Amount
101	2024-01-05	5000
102	2024-01-12	2500
107	2024-01-18	4000

Another Example (Between):

“Show orders between Feb 1, 2024 and Mar 31, 2024.”

Date Filters → **Between**

4. Custom Filters

Used to apply **multiple conditions** using AND/OR.

Business Question:

“Show orders where Amount > 5,000 AND Region = South.”

Steps

Amount → Number Filters → Custom Filter

Condition 1: Amount > 5000

AND

Condition 2: Region equals South

Result:

OrderID	Region	Amount
106	South	9500

Example with OR

“Show orders from North **or** West region.”

5. Basic vs Advanced Filtering

Basic Filter (Checkbox List)

Shows all values in a column.

Good for simple filtering.

Example:

Tick only → **Completed**

Advanced Filter

Used in **Number filters**, **Text filters**, **Date filters**, **Custom filters**.

Allows **multiple conditions**, comparison, contains, begins with, etc.

Example:

Amount > 5000 AND Status = Completed

GROUP BY

GROUP BY in Power Query

Group By is used to **summarize data** (aggregation), similar to **SQL GROUP BY** or **Excel Pivot Table**.

There are two modes:

1. Basic Mode

- Group by **one** column

- Apply **one** aggregation

2. Advanced Mode

- Group by **multiple** columns
- Apply **multiple** aggregations

Sample Dataset (Sales Transactions)

OrderID	Category	Region	Amount	Units
101	Electronics	North	5000	3
102	Furniture	South	2500	1
103	Electronics	East	8000	5
104	Electronics	North	3000	2
105	Furniture	West	1500	1
106	Furniture	South	9500	4

Basic mode

Basic mode allows:

- **One group-by column**
- **One aggregation**

Example 1: Total Sales by Category

Business Question:

“Give me total sales amount of each category.”

Steps

Home → Group By → **Basic Mode**

- Group By: **Category**
 - New column name: **Total Sales**
 - Operation: **Sum**
 - Column: **Amount**
-

Output

Category	Total Sales
Electronics	16000
Furniture	13500

Example 2: Count Orders by Region

Business Question:

“How many orders came from each region?”

Steps

Group By → Basic

- Group By: **Region**
 - New column: **Order Count**
 - Operation: **Count Rows**
-

Output

Region	Order Count
North	2
South	2

East	1
West	1

2. GROUP BY – ADVANCED MODE

Advanced mode allows:

- **Multiple grouped columns**
- **Multiple summary calculations**

Example: Sales Summary by Category + Region

Business Question:

“Show total sales and average units for each category in each region.”

Steps

Group By → **Advanced Mode**

Group By Columns:

- Category
- Region

Aggregations:

New Column	Operation	Column
Total Sales	Sum	Amount
Avg Units	Average	Units

Output

Category	Region	Total Sales	Avg Units
Electronics	North	8000	2.5

Electronics	East	8000	5
Furniture	South	12000	2.5
Furniture	West	1500	1

Supported Aggregation Types – Explained with Examples

Below are all aggregation types with business use cases.

Sum

Use Case: Total sales per category

Operation: Sum → Amount

Count Rows

Use Case: Number of employees in each department

Operation: Count Rows

Min / Max

Use Case: Find:

- Minimum order amount
 - Maximum units ordered
-

Average

Use Case: Average units sold per region

Median

Use Case: Median salary per department

Count Distinct Values

Use Case:

“How many UNIQUE customers per region?”

All Rows (Sub-Table)

Creates a **nested table** containing all rows of each group.

Use Case:

“You want a group-wise drilldown table.”

Example:

Group by Category → operation = **All Rows**

Output:

Each row contains a sub-table of records for that category.

Additional Real-Time Business Examples

Example 1: Sales by Category

Group By → Category

Aggregation → Sum → Amount

Example 2: Total Employees by Department

Use this HR Dataset:

EmpID	Department	Salary
E01	HR	30000
E02	IT	50000
E03	HR	32000
E04	Sales	45000
E05	IT	55000

Group By → Basic

Group By: Department

New Column: Employee Count

Operation: Count Rows

Output:

Department	Employee Count
HR	2
IT	2
Sales	1

Example 3: Min/Max Sales by Region

Region	Min Sales	Max Sales
North	3000	5000
South	2500	9500
East	8000	8000
West	1500	1500

ADD COLUMN in Power Query

The **Add Column** tab is used to create new fields based on formulas, logic, or transformations.

Common Add Column Options:

1. **Custom Column (M-code formula)**
2. **Index Column (0-based / 1-based / Custom)**
3. **Conditional Column**

4. **Invoke Custom Function**
5. **Add Column From Examples**

Sample Dataset (Sales Orders)

OrderID	Customer	Region	Amount	Order Date
101	John	North	5000	2024-01-05
102	Meera	South	2500	2024-01-12
103	Karan	East	8000	2024-02-10
104	John	North	3000	2024-02-18
105	Priya	West	1500	2024-03-02

1. Custom Column (M-Code Formula)

Used when you want to create a new column using mathematical or text formulas.

Business Requirement:

“Create a column that calculates 10% discount on Amount.”

Steps

Add Column → **Custom Column**

Formula:

=[Amount] * 0.10

Output Column: **Discount**

Result:

Amount	Discount

5000	500
2500	250
8000	800
3000	300
1500	150

Other Useful M-Code Formulas

Requirement	Formula
Full Name	[First] & " " & [Last]
Add tax (18%)	[Amount] * 0.18
Convert to text	Text.From([Amount])
Year	Date.Year([Order Date])
Month	Date.Month([Order Date])
If logic	if [Amount] > 5000 then "High" else "Low"

2. Index Column (Row Numbers)

Automatically generates sequence numbers.

Index Types:

- **0-based** → starts from 0
- **1-based** → starts from 1
- **Custom** → any number

Example

Business Requirement:

“Add a serial number starting from 1.”

Steps:

Add Column → **Index Column** → **From 1**

Output:

OrderID	Index
101	1
102	2
103	3
104	4
105	5

Custom Index Example

Start index at 500:

Value = 500 → Increment = 1

Creates: 500, 501, 502...

3. Conditional Column

(You already learned this earlier, but here it's summarized under Add Column)

Used to create logic-based columns.

Example:**Business Requirement:**

“Label orders as HIGH or LOW based on Amount.”

Steps:

Add Column → **Conditional Column**

Rule:

If Amount > 5000 → High

Else → Low

Output:

Amount	Category
5000	Low
2500	Low
8000	High
3000	Low
1500	Low

4. Invoke Custom Function

Used when you:

- ✓ Create a function in Power Query
- ✓ Want to apply it repeatedly

Example Scenario (Common in Real Projects)

You have multiple files monthly:

- Sales_Jan.csv
- Sales_Feb.csv
- Sales_Mar.csv

You create a function:

fxCleanSales

This function performs:

- Remove errors
- Trim text
- Fix date formats

Then:

Add Column → **Invoke Custom Function**

Select your function → apply to each file.

Business Use Case:

“We need to clean each imported Excel file using a cleaning function.”

Power Query applies the function to each row automatically.

5. Add Column From Examples

This is one of the most powerful features.

Power Query looks at **your examples** → creates formula automatically.

Example 1: Extract First Name

Customer column contains:

"Meera S"

Steps:

Add Column → **Column From Examples** → **From Selection**

Type: "Meera"

Power Query automatically identifies:

`Text.BeforeDelimiter([Customer], " ")`

Example 2: Create Month Name Column

Order Date = 2024-01-05

You type → "January"

Power Query generates:

```
Date.MonthName([Order Date])
```

COLUMN FROM EXAMPLES

Column From Examples allows you to **type the output you want**, and Power Query automatically generates the formula (M-code).

It is used when you **don't know the formula** or want **quick transformations**.

You can use it to:

- ✓ Extract first name
 - ✓ Extract domain from email
 - ✓ Format phone numbers
 - ✓ Auto-detect repeated patterns
-

Sample Dataset (Employee Information)

EmpID	Full Name	Email	Phone
E101	John Mathews	john.m@abc.com	9876543210
E102	Priya Suresh	priya.suresh@xyz.in	9567812345
E103	Rohan Kumar	rohan.kumar@mega.co.in	9123456789

1. Extract First Name

Business Requirement:

“Create a new column that contains only the first name.”

Steps:

1. Select **Full Name**
2. Add Column → **Column From Examples** → **From Selection**
3. In the new column, type:
 - For John Mathews → **John**
 - For Priya Suresh → **Priya**
4. Power Query auto-generates M-code:

```
Text.BeforeDelimiter([Full Name], " ")
```

Output

Full Name	First Name
John Mathews	John

Priya Suresh	Priya
Rohan Kumar	Rohan

2. Extract Domain From Email

Business Requirement:

“Extract the domain name from the email.”

Email: john.m@abc.com

Domain needed: **abc.com**

Steps:

Add Column → Column From Examples → From Selection

Type examples:

- For john.m@abc.com → **abc.com**
- For priya.suresh@xyz.in → **xyz.in**

Power Query auto-generates:

Text.AfterDelimiter([Email], "@")

Output

Email	Domain
john.m@abc.com	abc.com
priya.suresh@xyz.in	xyz.in
rohan.kumar@mega.co.in	mega.co.in

3. Format Phone Numbers

Current:

9876543210

Required format:

987-654-3210 (just an example)

Business Requirement:

“Convert phone numbers into formatted pattern.”

Steps:

Select **Phone** → Column From Examples.

Type:

- For 9876543210 → **987-654-3210**

Power Query automatically identifies pattern and generates formula like:

`Text.Middle([Phone], 0, 3) & "-" & Text.Middle([Phone], 3, 3) & "-" & Text.Middle([Phone], 6, 4)`

Output

Phone	Formatted Phone
9876543210	987-654-3210
9567812345	956-781-2345
9123456789	912-345-6789

4. Auto Detect Patterns

Power Query automatically picks patterns when:

- Extracting first/last names
- Extracting ID from codes (e.g., ORD-9852 → 9852)

- Splitting based on spaces/dots/dashes
 - Creating codes like EMP-101, EMP-102
 - Concatenating multiple fields
-

Example Dataset

Code
EMP-001
EMP-002
EMP-003

Business Requirement:

“Extract only the numeric part.”

Steps:

Type:

- 001
- 002

Power Query auto-generates:

`Text.AfterDelimiter([Code], "-")`

DATA TYPE CONVERSION

Every column in Power Query must have a correct **data type**, because:

- ✓ Calculations depend on it
- ✓ Sorting & filtering change

- ✓ Date functions work only on date types
- ✓ Text functions work only on text types

Supported Data Types

Data Type	Used For	Example Values
Whole Number	Counts, ID fields	10, 250, 1001
Decimal Number	Amounts, percentages, averages	1250.50
Text	Names, emails, codes	“John”, “ORD-123”
Date	Order date, join date	2024-03-05
Date/Time	Timestamps	2024-03-05 12:45
Boolean	TRUE/FALSE conditions	TRUE, FALSE

Sample Dataset

OrderID	Order Date	Amount	Customer	Active
101	05-03-2024	1500.75	John	TRUE
102	12-03-2024	900	Priya	FALSE
103	2024/03/18	450.5	Kiran	TRUE
104	18-03-2024	1750	Anu	TRUE

1. Whole Number Conversion

Used when the column contains **IDs, counts, quantity**.

Example:

- OrderID = 101 → Whole Number

- Quantity = 5 → Whole Number

Steps

Home → Data Type → Whole Number

Problem if incorrect

If text values like “001” exist → converting to number becomes **1**
(leading zeros lost)

2. Decimal Number Conversion

Used for:

- ✓ Amounts
- ✓ Prices
- ✓ Discounts
- ✓ Percentages

Example:

- 1500.75 → Decimal Number
- 900 → Decimal Number

Power Query automatically converts integers (900) to 900.00 (decimal type).

3. Text Conversion

Used for:

- ✓ Names
- ✓ Product Codes
- ✓ Phone numbers
- ✓ Customer IDs (with letters)

Example Problem:

If phone number 9876543210 becomes a **Whole Number**,
it may show as **9.87654E+09** (scientific format).

Solution → Convert to **Text**.

4. Date Conversion

Used for:

- ✓ Order Date
- ✓ Invoice Date
- ✓ Join Date

Power Query supports many date formats:

- 05-03-2024
- 2024/03/18
- 03/05/2024
- 2024-03-05

After conversion, Power Query shows a calendar icon

- ✓ Date recognized
- ✗ If error appears → wrong format

5. Date/Time Conversion

Used when column contains timestamp:

Example:

Date/Time
2024-03-05 10:45 AM
2024-03-06 16:32

Used for:

- ✓ Log files
- ✓ Tracking updates
- ✓ Reporting refresh times

6. Boolean Conversion (TRUE/FALSE)

Used for logical fields:

- Active

- Passed/Failed
- Available/Not available

Power Query accepts:

Text	Converted Boolean
"TRUE"	TRUE
"FALSE"	FALSE
"Yes/No"	(must clean first)

Common Data Type Issues & Fixes

1. Wrong Date Format

Example:

- "05-03-2024" interpreted as **May 3rd** instead of **March 5th**

Fix:

Use *Locale Conversion*

Transform → Data Type → **Using Locale**

Choose

- Data Type = Date
- Locale = English (India) or dd-MM-yyyy

2. Text interpreted as Number

Examples:

Value	Problem
00123	Converted to 123 (leading zeros lost)
9876543210	Shown as 9.87654E+09

Fix → Set Data Type = **Text**

3. Mixed Data Types

Example:

Value
1500
1800.50
"N/A"

Converting to Decimal → errors appear.

Fix sequence:

1. Replace "N/A" → null
2. Change type → Decimal Number

4. Date column containing time

If time exists but type is only **Date** → time is removed.

Fix → Set **Date/Time** type

PIVOT & UNPIVOT in Power Query

These are two of the MOST powerful data transformation features.

1. PIVOT COLUMNS

Pivot = Convert rows → columns

Used to *summarize* data by spreading values across new columns.

Real Business Example (Before Pivot)

Sales Table (Unpivoted)

Product	Year	Sales
Laptop	2022	150000
Laptop	2023	180000
Tablet	2022	90000
Tablet	2023	120000
Mobile	2022	220000
Mobile	2023	250000

Goal:

Convert data to this format:

Product	2022 Sales	2023 Sales
Laptop	150000	180000
Tablet	90000	120000
Mobile	220000	250000

How to Pivot in Power Query

Steps:

1. Select: **Year column** → this becomes new column headers
2. Select **Transform** → **Pivot Column**
3. Values Column = **Sales**
4. Aggregation = **Sum** (default)

Why Pivot is useful?

- ✓ Compare year-wise sales
 - ✓ Create reporting format
 - ✓ Easy to visualize in Power BI visuals
 - ✓ Convert long (tall) data into wide layout
-

More Pivot Examples

Example: Region-wise Sales (Pivot Region)

Before:

Region	Month	Sales
South	Jan	25000
North	Jan	30000
South	Feb	27000
North	Feb	31000

After Pivot (Region as columns):

Month	South	North
Jan	25000	30000
Feb	27000	31000

2. UNPIVOT COLUMNS

Unpivot = Convert columns → rows

Opposite of pivot. Makes data *longer*, ideal for analysis.

Real Business Example (Before Unpivot)

Sales Report (wide format)

Product	Jan	Feb	Mar
Laptop	50000	52000	51000
Mobile	70000	68000	69000
Tablet	30000	32000	31000

Goal: Convert Jan, Feb, Mar columns into rows:

Product	Month	Sales
Laptop	Jan	50000
Laptop	Feb	52000
Laptop	Mar	51000
Mobile	Jan	70000
Mobile	Feb	68000
Mobile	Mar	69000
Tablet	Jan	30000
Tablet	Feb	32000
Tablet	Mar	31000

How to Unpivot in Power Query

Steps:

1. Select column(s) to **keep** (Product)
2. Right-click → **Unpivot Other Columns**

Power Query creates:

- **Attribute** column → Month
 - **Value** column → Sales
-

Why Unpivot is VERY important?

- ✓ Converts Excel-like reports into usable data
 - ✓ Required for date intelligence
 - ✓ Helps DAX work correctly
 - ✓ Best for visuals (e.g., Month axis needs rows)
-

More Unpivot Examples

Example: Employee Attendance (Wide → Long)

Before:

Emp	Jan	Feb	Mar
John	P	P	A
Priya	A	P	P

After Unpivot:

Emp	Month	Status
John	Jan	P
John	Feb	P
John	Mar	A
Priya	Jan	A

Priya	Feb	P
Priya	Mar	P